هاكاثون HACKATHON UAE الإمارات

BEYOND IDEAS .. INTO IMPACT يصنع الأثر .. يتجاوز الفكرة

بتنظيم من Organized by

TDRA هيئة تنظيم الاتصالات والحكومة الرقمية TELECOMMUNICATIONS AND DIGITAL GOVERNMENT REGULATORY AUTHORITY | ICTFUND صندوق الاتصالات وتقنية المعلومات INFORMATION & COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY FUND

UAE HACKATHON 2026: TRACK 2 (PIONEERS & RISING STARS)

Your questions, answered.

EVENT SCHEDULE & ROADMAP

Pick one location • 3 days in-person: 2 days mentorship & training + 1 judging day

Website: hackathon.ae

26–28 Oct	28–30 Oct	2–4 Nov	4–6 Nov	9–11 Nov	16 Nov	18 Nov – 3 Dec
Abu Dhabi	**Umm Al Quwain & Ras Al Khaimah**	**Sharjah & Ajman**	**Fujairah**	**Dubai**	**Innovation Summit & Announcement**	**Two weeks post-hackathon phase for winners**
Choueifat international schools - Yas Island	University of Umm Al Quwain	Higher Colleges of Technology - Sharjah, Campus A	University of Fujairah	Higher Colleges of Technology - Dubai, Student Campus		

01 WHO CAN JOIN & HOW TO REGISTER

Who can take part in Track 2?

Pioneers: university students aged 17–25, including recent graduates (23–25) and postgraduates under 25.
Rising Stars: school students aged 11–17 years old.

Can I join if I'm over 25, a private-sector employee or a startup?

Track 2 is for under-25s only, and registration for Entrepreneurs/Track 1 is closed. Follow us for the next edition.

Is registration still open? What is the deadline?

Yes. You can register right up until the hackathon dates.

Which participation type do I choose?

Students choose **Challenge Solver**. Teachers and coaches choose **Mentor**.

I don't have a UAE Pass (for example, students under 16). What do I do?

Register in person at the hackathon.

Registration shows an "unexpected error". What now?

Try again. If it keeps happening, reply to the official email you received about the session and tell us.

Is there a selection round after I register?

An invitation to attend the hackathon will be sent to everyone who has registered. If anyone encounters difficulties in the registration process, they can register on-site, provided they fall within the target age group.

02 TEAMS

Do I need a team? Can I join solo?

A team is a must: **2 to 7 members**. Duos and trios are fine.

The website only lets me add 5 members. What about the rest?

The portal currently fits 5. Any additional members can simply register physically at the hackathon.

I don't know anyone. How do I find teammates?

Form or join a team during the hackathon days.

How do I create a team and invite members?

Log in with UAE Pass, open **My Team**, then **Create Team**. Use the **+** button to invite. You are added automatically as team leader.

Can I invite someone who hasn't registered?

No. Every teammate must register first. Then invite them with the email they used on the portal.

Can teammates be from different schools?

Yes, for example you can team up with a sibling from another school.

Can I create the team first and add the idea later? Can I change the idea or team name?

Yes, both are correct. You are free to edit your submission until the final deadline on judging day. If you encounter any issues with the portal, please send us an email and we will be happy to assist you.

03 LOCATIONS, DATES & ATTENDANCE

Which hackathon do I attend?

Only **one**. Choose the location you can reach and make sure your portal application matches it. You don't have to live in that emirate.

Do we attend all three days?

Yes. Every team member attends all 3 days of the chosen location.

Can I join online or in a hybrid way?

No. The hackathon is in person only.

Where are the venues?

Abu Dhabi: SABIS Yas Island.
Umm Al Quwain & Ras Al Khaimah - University of Umm Al Quwain.
Sharjah & Ajman - Higher Colleges of Technology - Sharjah, Campus A.
Fujairah - University of Fujairah.
Dubai - Higher Colleges of Technology - Dubai, Student Campus.

What are the daily timings?

From 8:00 AM to 4:00 PM daily, and the full agenda will be sent for each location ASAP.

Is accommodation provided for those who live far away?

No, we only host the event. Please choose the nearest location.

Why are the dates different for each emirate?

Every location runs the same 3-day programme, so each team gets the same experience.

04 MENTORS & TEACHERS

I'm a teacher. How do I join my students?

Register as a **Mentor** (not Challenge Solver). Mentor profiles are reviewed by the organisers before activation.

My mentor doesn't appear in the list. Why?

Mentor accounts take some time to become visible. They must register as a Mentor first. In My Team, use the button beside **+**.

Do we need a mentor?

No, you can attend without one. You will also meet more mentors face to face at the hackathon.

How many teams can one mentor guide?

More than one, including teams working on different themes.

05 CHALLENGES & THEMES

Where do I find the challenges?

On the hackathon website. They come from government entities, and you can choose any challenge, whichever emirate it is from.

Can we write our own challenge statement?

If your challenge track has no challenges listed, then yes. But if the challenge track has listed challenges, then pick one.

Which theme fits my idea?

Pick a challenge from the challenge list to solve with your solution.

Are challenges revealed on the day?

They are available in advance on the website.

06 FORMAT, PREPARATION & RULES

What happens during the three days?

Two days of mentorship and training, then one judging day.

How should I prepare? Is it beginner friendly?

Register, form your team, pick a challenge and bring a clear idea. Read the detailed email we send before the hackathon.

Can we start before the hackathon?

Yes, you can start early and keep developing during the days. There is no online submission before the event.

Do we need a working prototype?

You present your idea and solution. Any development you add makes it stronger.

What should we bring?

Your own laptop.

Can we use AI tools?

Yes. This year UAE-Hackathon focus on AI usage and you will use the AI during the training days.

Is there a dress code? Do we bring parents?

No dress code, and school uniform is not required. Parents are welcome to attend if they want to.

When will resources be shared?

Resources are shared during the hackathon days.

07 PRESENTATION & JUDGING

How long is the presentation?

3 minutes to present, plus **2 minutes** for the judges' questions.

Who presents and in what format?

All team members take part. Present slides on a screen to the judges, using any software you like, in Arabic or English. The Business Model Canvas is one page of your presentation.

How are winners chosen?

One fixed set of criteria at every location take place. The top 10 teams win in each track.

Is presenting limited to selected teams?

During the hackathon, you will be asked to submit your presentation at deadline, the submitted teams will present.

STILL HAVE A QUESTION?

Reply to the official email you received about the session.

Note: The session recording and slides will be emailed to all attendees.